

Emmanuel Karanja

Software Engineer | Product Designer

SUMMARY

Full-stack engineer and Product Designer with 5+ years shipping production software across SaaS, fintech, and ed-tech; from Figma prototype to platforms serving 250k+ users. Founder of a school ERP SaaS platform, owning product, engineering, and go-to-market solo; previously delivered for US-based startups on aggressive timelines.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & CTO

Edara Technologies Ltd

Oct 2025 - Present

Nairobi, Kenya - Remote

- Took Elimu Bora ERP from zero to its first paying school customer, by single-handedly owning product strategy, UI/UX design, engineering, and go-to-market.
- Architected a secure multi-tenant SaaS platform on Laravel, Filament, Vue.js, and Inertia.js, enforcing tenant isolation with PostgreSQL row-level security, deployed via DigitalOcean / Laravel Forge.
- Designed and shipped the core workflows Kenyan schools depend on i.e. CBC & 8-4-4 grading, fee collection & finance reconciliation, attendance tracking, and a parent portal.
- Worked on the company’s marketing and sales strategy i.e. Google Business Profile, Google Ads, social content, self help docs and the Cloudflare Workers-hosted website.

Stack: Laravel, Typescript, Vue.js, PostgreSQL, Figma

Full Stack Web Developer & UI/UX Designer

Blue Book Publications, Inc.

Jul 2023 - Jan 2026

Alabama, USA - Remote

- Served as sole UI/UX designer and lead developer for the company’s digital platform, supporting 250k+ registered users and 55k weekly actives.
- Increased conversion and engagement by 30% by leading end-to-end UI/UX overhauls in Figma across core product flows.
- Improved user discoverability and search satisfaction by architecting a new Algolia-powered search experience.
- Designed and shipped a new marketplace feature end-to-end, growing engagement and earning recognition from leadership for design quality and product vision.

Stack: Laravel, Vue.js, MySQL, Figma

Full Stack Web Developer & UI/UX Designer

Chani AI

Feb 2023 - Jun 2023

New York, USA - Remote

- Contributed to onboarding and retaining the company’s first 3 paying clients by partnering directly with founders on product direction and shipping rapid, customer-centric iterations.
- Owned the majority of frontend development in Vue.js and contributed to backend services in NestJS, balancing speed and quality on aggressive timelines.
- Designed and prototyped core user flows in Figma to streamline client onboarding and improve usability.

Stack: Typescript, Angular, NestJS, MySQL, Figma

Full Stack Web Developer & UI/UX Designer

SYNTAX LTD

May 2021 - Feb 2023

Nairobi, Kenya - On site

- Designed and shipped UIs for a finance app supporting 20,000+ users, a real estate portal, and an NFT platform, across full project lifecycles.
- Owned complete UI/UX design for a chess mobile game and a delivery web app, partnering closely with stakeholders to rapidly iterate prototypes in Figma and Adobe XD.
- Strengthened site performance and search visibility via backend development in Laravel and SEO / server-reliability improvements.

Stack: Laravel, Vue.js, MySQL, Figma

IT Intern

The Dream Factory Kenya

Feb 2020 - May 2020

Nairobi, Kenya - On site

- Supported database design and maintenance in MySQL and PHP, and assisted with UI prototyping and frontend development in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Contributed to client SEO initiatives alongside a cross-functional engineering team.

Stack: Laravel, Vue.js, MySQL

-  <https://ekaranja.me>
-  <https://github.com/ekaranjaa>
-  <https://linkedin.com/in/ekaranjaa>
-  karanjaemmanuel8@gmail.com

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks

PHP, Laravel, TypeScript, Vue.js, Tailwind CSS, NestJS.

Database

MySQL, PostgreSQL, GraphQL, Redis, Algolia.

Cloud & DevOps

AWS, Docker, CI/CD pipelines, Nginx, Apache.

Design

Figma, Adobe XD, Illustrator, After Effects.

EDUCATION

Bsc. Science in Applied Computing

KCA University

May 2019 - April 2023

REFERENCES

Available upon request.